Fourth, Coal India is a holding company with seven subsidiaries. The holding company should be disbanded by merging it with a sovereign asset management company (SAMC). The nationalization of coal mines in 1973 needs to be undone with the SAMC privatizing all seven subsidiaries over a period of seven to ten years.

Fifth, SAIL has about 15 per cent share in steel production in the country. This share is steadily going down. There are a few other steel plants, directly and indirectly owned by the Government of India. NMDC is setting up a 3 million tonne steel plant in Nagarnar, Bastar. Over Rs 17,000 crore of the estimated cost of Rs 23,000 crore has been invested by NMDC in building this small-capacity plant. The plant has been under construction for over seven years with completion and commissioning nowhere in sight. MMTC, already sick itself, has built a small 1.1 million tonne plant housed in its subsidiary Neelanchal Ispat Nigam Ltd. There is another small steel plant constructed and operated by another Government of India company, Rashtriya Ispat Nigam Limited (RINL). Steelmaking has been very competitively and qualitatively established in the private sector in India. There is absolutely no need for the government to continue running steel plants. SAIL and all other directly and indirectly owned steel companies of the Government of India should be privatized. The Ministry of Steel should simply be wound up.

Sixth, the government is heavily present in the oil and gas space. ONGC and OIL are in exploration as well as oil and gas refining and marketing. The government has initiated consolidation and privatization in these businesses. HPCL was sold to ONGC to make the ONGC-HPCL combine have an interest from the upstream to downstream in the oil and gas sector, from exploration of oil to marketing of petroleum products. BPCL has been put on the block. The process of privatizing oil and gas refining and marketing must be taken to its logical end. Perhaps one integrated entity of